HARIAKSHA GUNDA

Curriculum Vitae

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EDUCATION

The University of Alabama — Tuscaloosa, AL
B.S. in Data Science — 08/2022 – 05/2027

- Minors: Mathematics, Computer Science, Economics
- Relevant Coursework: Development Economics, Non-Linear Optimization Theory, Real Analysis I-II, Machine Learning, Database Management Systems
- GPA: 4.00/4.00

The University of Alabama — Tuscaloosa, AL
B.A. in Foreign Languages and Literature — 08/2022 – 05/2027

- Concentration: German Language and Literature
- Minors: International Studies, Public Policy Studies, Global and Cultural Perspectives
- Relevant Coursework: Issues in Global Governance, Environmental Decision-Making, International Social Work, American Public Policy
- GPA: 4.00/4.00

EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, UA Culverhouse College of Business — 01/2024 – Present
Research Assistant, The University of Chicago — 06/2026 – 07/2026
Visiting Researcher, Paderborn Research Center for Sustainable Economy — 05/2025 - 08/2025
Data Scientist, Planet Indonesia International — 12/2024 - 04/2025
Research Assistant, UA Digital Forensics and Cyber Security Lab — 08/2023 - 12/2023
Data Scientist, Alabama Department of Public Health Center for Health Statistics — 05/2023 - 06/2023

HONORS AND AWARDS

Ambassador, Institute for Economics and Peace — 04/2026 – Present
Scholarship (7x, applied each semester), Zeta Psi Educational Foundation — 01/2023 – 03/2026
REAL List: Global and Intercultural Learning Top 25, The University of Alabama — 12/2025
Microsoft Emerging Leader, Microsoft Security — 04/2025 – Present
Gilman Scholars Brussels EU Study Tour Selection, US Department of State — 06/2025
National Award for Undergraduates of German, German National Honor Society — 04/2025
Gilman Research Scholarship, US Department of State — 12/2024 - 08/2025
Boren Scholarship, US Department of Defense — 04/2024 - 04/2025
Outstanding Cultural Organization, UA (associated with South Asian Culture Club) — 04/2024
Critical Language Scholarship, US Department of State (declined) — 03/2024
Excellence Second-Year, University of Alabama German Department — 04/2023
Best Event Award, UA (associated with South Asian Culture Club Mock Shaadi) — 04/2023
Children of Associates Premier Scholarship (3x), H&R Block — 09/2022 – 09/2023
Crimson Scholar, The University of Alabama — 08/2022 – 05/2024
National Merit Finalist Scholarship, National Merit Scholarship Corporation — 04/2022

PRESENTATIONS

Oral Presentations

World Congress on Undergraduate Research (WorldCUR), Zayed University, Dubai, United Arab Emirates (accepted). January 2027. *Smoke and Strife: Wind-Instrumented Fire Exposure and Social Conflict in Indonesia*

Paderborn Research Center for Sustainable Economy Brown Bag Seminar. August 2025. *The Economics of Data Privacy: Regulatory Uncertainty and Corporate Responses to the EU GDPR*

Planet Indonesia International Intern Symposium. April 2025. *Marine Environmental Risk Assessments for Indonesian Provinces using Data on Ecology and Socio-economic and Environmental Resilience*

State University of Malang Student Seminars. December 2024. *Assessment of Marine Environmental Risks in Indonesia*

Poster Presentations

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. April 2026. *The Heat Is On: Causal Impacts of Wildfires on Conflict Probability and Intensity in Indonesia*

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. April 2026. *The Economics of Data Privacy: Regulatory Uncertainty and Corporate Responses to the EU GDPR*

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. March 2024. *The Impact of Linguistic Features on Revenues using NLP on Mission Statements of Tax-Exempt Organizations*

CERTIFICATIONS AND SPECIAL LEARNING

Documenting Development Data Using Metadata Standards, The World Bank Group 08/2026
Responsible AI in a Global Context, United Nations University 07/2026
How Tech Drives Sustainability, LinkedIn Learning 06/2026
IEP Ambassador Seminars, Institute for Economics and Peace 05/2026
Positive Peace Academy, Institute for Economics and Peace 02/2026
Microsoft Emerging Leader Professional Development Series, Microsoft Security 08/2025
Climate Catalysts Mentorship Program, UNFCCC 05/2025
Becoming a Climate Champion, UNITAR 04/2025
Digital4Sustainability Learning Path, UNSSC 03/2025
Supervised Machine Learning: Regression and Classification, DeepLearning.AI 02/2025
AI For Everyone, DeepLearning.AI 01/2024
Cybersecurity Foundations Specialization, InfoSEC 05/2023
Python Essential Training, LinkedIn Learning 11/2022

PROJECTS

The University of Alabama 01/2026 – Present
Principal Investigator *Working Paper*

- Smoke and Strife: Fire Exposure and Social Conflict in Indonesia

The University of Chicago, The University of Alabama, The University of Toronto 10/2025 – Present
Research Assistant to Dr. John List, Dr. Michael Price, and Dr. Angela Doku *Working Paper*

- Reading the Storm: Media Attribution of United States Climate Disasters, A Long Panel

The University of Alabama 01/2024 – 05/2024
Research Assistant to Dr. Michael Price *No longer active*

- Impact of Mission Statement Linguistic Features on Nonprofit Revenues

ZEW Mannheim, The University of Alabama 05/2025 – 08/2025
Research Assistant to Dr. Martin Kesternich and Dr. Michael Price *No longer active*

- The Effects of GDPR on Firm Behavior and Innovation

Planet Indonesia International 12/2024 – 04/2025
Data Scientist with Adam Miller *Completed*

- Marine Environmental Risk Assessments for Indonesian Provinces

EXTRACURRICULARS AND AFFILIATIONS

Research Ambassador, UA Office of Undergraduate Research 04/2026 – 05/2027
Member, Blue Key Honor Society 04/2026 – Present
Member, Phi Kappa Phi Honor Society 04/2026 – Present

Member, Pi Mu Epsilon, the National Honor Society for Mathematics	04/2026 – Present
Member, UA Philomathic Literary Society	03/2026 – 05/2027
Member, UA Education Abroad Alumni Association	03/2026 – Present
President, United Nations Association of the USA at UA	08/2025 – 05/2026
Technology Mechanisms Working Group Member, UNFCCC YOUNGO	06/2025 – Present
Member, United Nations Association of the USA	06/2025 – 06/2026
Member, Asian Environmental Youth Network	06/2025 – Present
Data Volunteer, Oxford Net Zero Tracker	05/2025 – Present
Member, Delta Phi Alpha (German National Honor Society)	05/2024 – Present
Member, National Security Education Program (NSEP) Alumni Association	05/2024 – Present
Honors College Ambassador, UA Honors College	03/2024 – 05/2027
Scholarship Officer, Zeta Psi International Fraternity	01/2023 – 05/2027
Member, Golden Key Honor Society	09/2022 – Present
Secretary & Advisor, UA South Asian Culture Club	08/2022 – 05/2027
Member, Association for Computing Machinery	08/2022 – Present
Member, Society of Asian Scientists and Engineers	08/2022 – Present
Member, UA German Club	08/2022 – 05/2027
Choreographer, Teacher, Dancer, Nach Basanti (Indian fusion dance team)	08/2022 – 05/2027

FEATURED

Podcasts

Put the Guidebook Down. April 2026. *Speaking the Place: How Language Changes the Way You Travel*

Put the Guidebook Down. December 2025. *The Power of a Gap Year: Breaking Out of the Linear Life Path*

Datasets

Oxford Net Zero Tracker. September 2025. *Net Zero Stocktake 2025*

SKILLS

Technical Skills: Python, Econometrics, Field Experiments, R, SQL, MATLAB, TensorFlow, Webscraping, Database Management, Git, HTML/CSS/JS, LaTeX, Stata, QGIS

Languages: *German* (CEFR B1: Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Indonesian* (ACTFL 2: Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Malay* (Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Telugu* (Basic)